

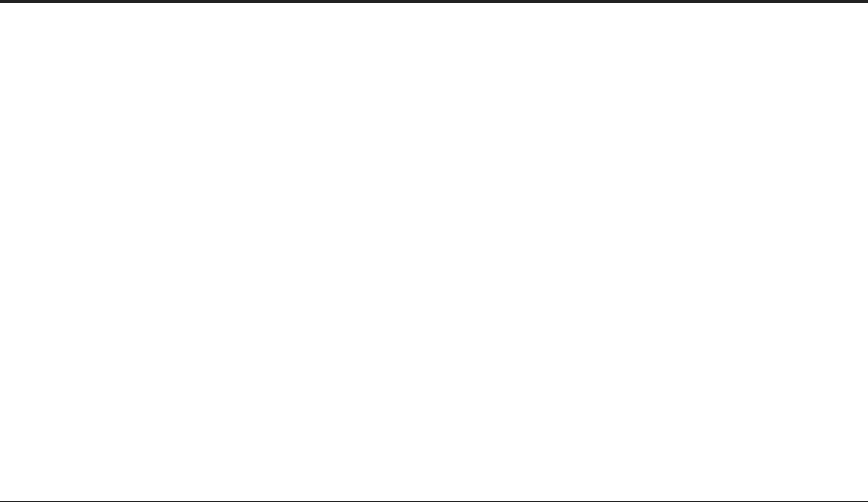
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Jeffrey Epstein's brother claims released suicide note is a 'forgery': report

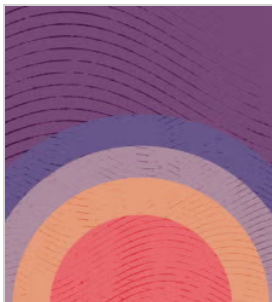
A federal court on Wednesday released an alleged suicide note Epstein wrote in prison in 2019 before his death a month later

Josh Marcus in San Francisco

Friday 08 May 2026 19:34 EDT



What was in Epstein's alleged suicide note?



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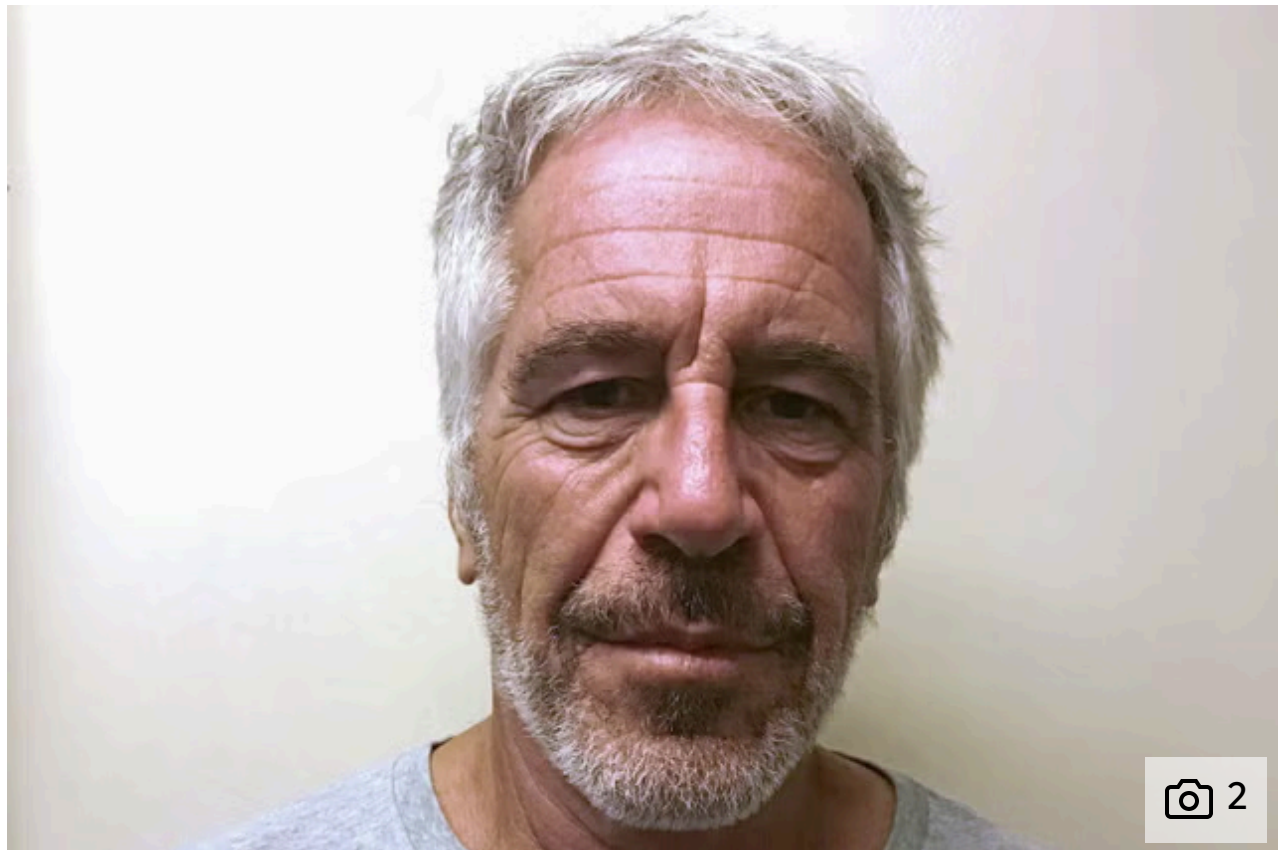
Jeffrey Epstein's brother believes his brother's **purported suicide note**, released this week in court, is fake.

Mark Epstein, **speaking with *The National Enquirer***, called the document a "forgery."

"I've known Jeff all my life. If he was going to kill himself, if he was going to write a **suicide note**, he would've written it 'to somebody,' not just a blanket statement saying goodbye," Epstein said. "I don't buy that."

Jeffrey Epstein's former cellmate claims to have discovered **the document** in July 2019, after Epstein was found unresponsive but alive in his cell. Epstein died by suicide the following month.

"It's bulls**t and let me explain why," Epstein's brother added in the *National Enquirer* interview. "In **the July incident**, Jeffrey's cellmate attacked him, he reported it as such, he told his lawyer as such, and then he recanted that story saying he couldn't remember what happened because he was fearful of retaliation."



Jeffrey Epstein's brother doesn't believe an alleged suicide note released in court is real (*New York State Division of Criminal Justice*)

"It is a treat to be able to choose one's time to say goodbye," **the note**, released in federal court on Wednesday, reads. "Watcha want me to do —

Bust out cryin!!”

“NO FUN,” the message concludes. “NOT WORTH IT!!”

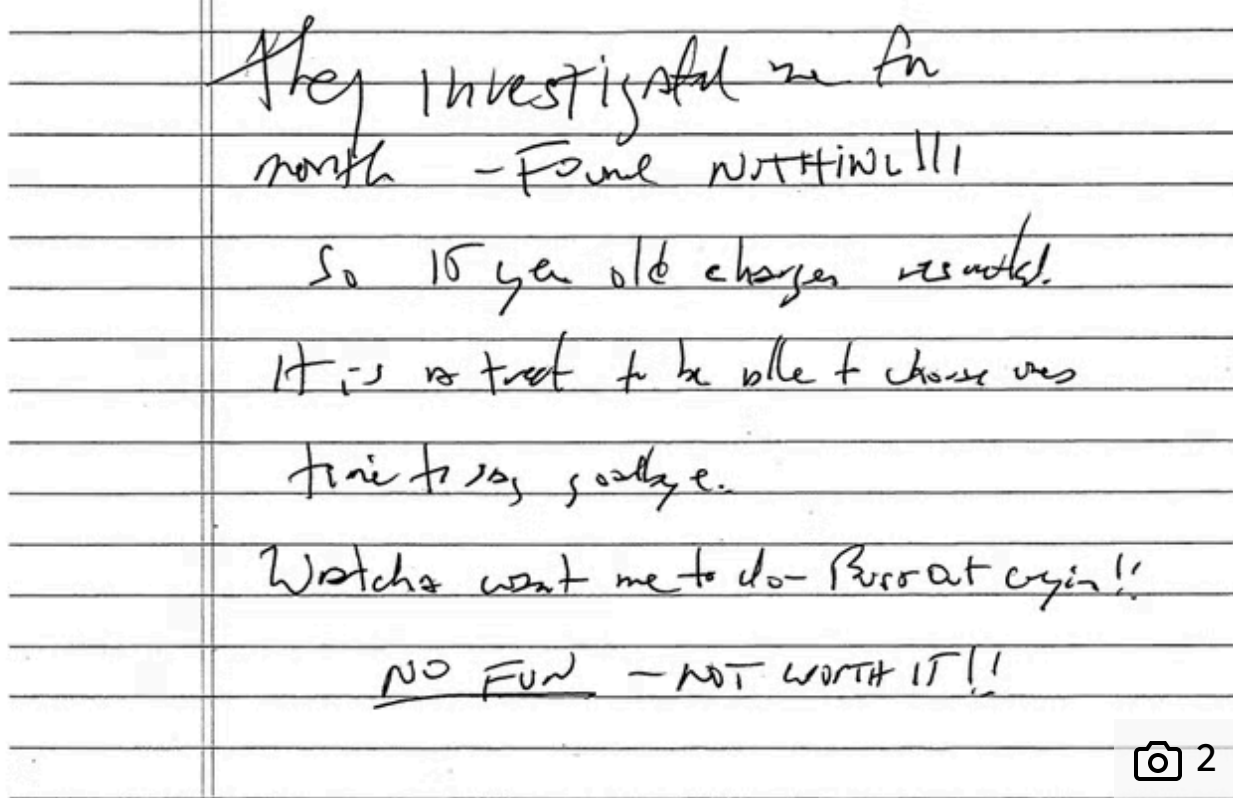
Epstein’s cellmate, Nicholas Tartaglione, claims he discovered the message inside a book in July 2019 after the first incident.

Epstein initially claimed that Tartaglione, a former police officer convicted of leading a murder plot, tried to kill him, but the disgraced financier did not subsequently repeat the claim after he was moved to another cell.

The note was initially sealed in court records, but Tartaglione later **described it to *The New York Times* and reporter Jessica Reed Kraus**. The paper then petitioned for the document to be released publicly.

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They investigated me for
months - Found NOTHING!!
So 15 year old charges resulted.
It is so hard to be able to choose ones
time to say goodbye.
Watcha want me to do - Bust out cryin!!
NO FUN - NOT WORTH IT!!

A photograph of a handwritten note on lined paper. The text is written in dark ink and appears to be a suicide note. The note is written in a cursive, somewhat slanted script. The paper has horizontal lines. In the bottom right corner, there is a small icon of a camera and the number 2.

Epstein’s former cellmate claimed he found the alleged suicide note wedged in a book (*U.S. District Court for the Southern District of New York*)

On Monday, the Justice Department **backed the request**.

Though officials determined that Jeffrey Epstein died by suicide, his brother has long argued that this is incorrect.

Mark Epstein told *The National Enquirer* that a forthcoming review of his brother's autopsy would prove the death wasn't a suicide.

“Anybody who still thinks it's a suicide after the report comes out; they should be declared brain dead,” he said.

Nearly seven years after Jeffrey Epstein's death, the scandal around his sex ring continues.

On Wednesday, Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick answered questions about his past ties to Epstein during a closed-door deposition before the **House Oversight Committee**.

If you are based in the USA, and you or someone you know needs mental health assistance right now, call or text 988 or visit 988lifeline.org to access online chat from the 988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline. This is a free, confidential crisis hotline that is available to everyone 24 hours a day, seven days a week. If you are in another country, you can go to www.befrienders.org to find a helpline near you. In the UK, people having mental health crises can contact the Samaritans at [116 123](tel:116123) or jo@samaritans.org

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